Emerging Travel Group: a daily commercial & pricing cockpit for a multi-brand B2B travel platform

Public market data, a real hotel-booking dataset and a simulated sales ledger, turned into daily monitoring, root-cause analysis and a price-match decision process.

REAL DATASET · PAGE 3

41% vs 17%

cancellation rate of travel-agent bookings vs direct bookings, on 119,390 real hotel bookings

REAL DATASET · PAGE 4

82%

of a real €519k monthly revenue drop came from mix and price, not from fewer room nights

SIMULATED · PAGE 6

€122k

margin lost to monthly lira price lists lagging the real ECB rate: the costliest, and the slowest, event

SIMULATED · PAGE 8

58%

of price-match claims survive a like-for-like check; matching within the floor saved €134k of sales

Business questions

1 · **Context** What does ETG sell, at what scale, and where is the margin made? (p.1)
2 · **Demand** Which source markets matter and what is "normal" seasonality for each? (p.2)
3 · **Channels** How do B2B bookings differ from direct ones on real data? (p.3-4)
4 · **Monitoring** Is today normal, and if not, why? (p.5-7)
5 · **Pricing** When to grant a price match, and where to move markups? (p.8-9)

Recommendations: check data quality before any conclusion; read every move against the same weekday and the market's own calendar; refresh local-currency price lists weekly; re-route Spanish demand away from the supplier whose rates rose; decide price matches with a written like-for-like checklist and a 4% margin floor; test +0.5 pt markups only where price pressure is low.

Data & methods

PUBLIC DATA ETG web pages (live and archived), Eurostat tourism statistics, ECB exchange rates.
REAL DATASET Hotel booking demand (Antonio, Almeida & Nunes, 2019, CC BY 4.0): two hotels in Portugal, 2015-2017, used to demonstrate the analysis, not ETG data.
SIMULATED An 18-month daily sales ledger (192k bookings, seed 42) calibrated on public orders of magnitude, with seven programmed events. Not ETG data.

Excel Power Pivot model, ~50 DAX measures, CUBE formulas, PivotTables with slicers, dynamic arrays, price-match calculator.
SQL DuckDB queries: segments, joins, alert band, top variations, data checks.
Python collection, simulation, variance bridges, alert scoring.

How to read this report

Titles state the conclusion of the page. **Tags** PUBLIC DATA / REAL DATASET / SIMULATED mark where the data comes from. **Blue** = data, **grey** = comparison, **red** = alert or below the margin floor, **dashed lines** = thresholds. **Code** scripts, SQL, Excel workbook and sources are in the repository.

ETG connects 350+ suppliers to 110K+ agents and 1,400+ API partners: its margin is the gap between net rates and B2B selling prices

PUBLIC DATA

What the company publishes about itself (emergingtravel.com, live and archived, collected 12 Nov 2026). No financial detail is published beyond these headline figures.

TRAVEL AGENTS (RATEHAWK)	SUPPLIERS	API PARTNERS	DIRECT PROPERTIES	BOOKINGS PER WEEK	ANNUAL TURNOVER (USD)
110K+	350+	1,400+	250K+	130K+	2.6BN+

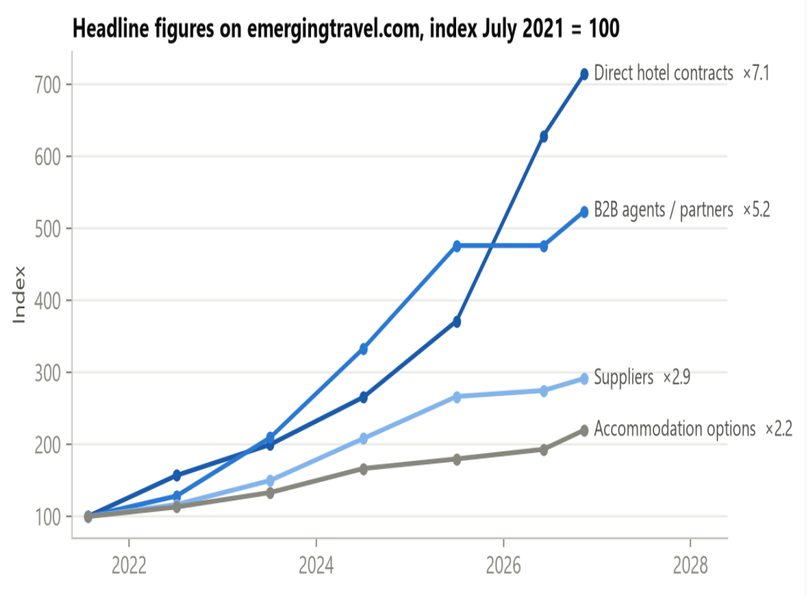
Three brands, one inventory

RateHawk · B2B booking tool for travel professionals: hotels, flights, transfers, car rentals (110K+ agents).
ZenHotels · B2C hotel booking site for individual travellers (1.3M+ travellers).
Roundtrip · corporate travel platform, est. 2022 (5K+ corporate clients).
Extranet · hotels distribute directly (250K+ direct properties, 80+ channel managers).
Also: 1,400+ API partners, white label and affiliate programmes; 3.3M+ accommodation options in 190+ source markets; search answers in 50 ms over 360K rates per second.

Where the margin is made

Suppliers hotels direct, bedbanks, wholesalers sell a **net rate** → **ETG** adds a **markup** by brand, segment, market → **Clients** agents, API partners, companies, travellers

Margin = selling price − supplier net cost. It moves with the net rate (supplier), the markup (pricing), the currency the client pays in (FX), and the mix of brands, markets and partners. A **price-match request** arrives when a partner sees the same room cheaper elsewhere: the analyst checks it is the same product, then grants a discount, switches supplier, or refuses with arguments.



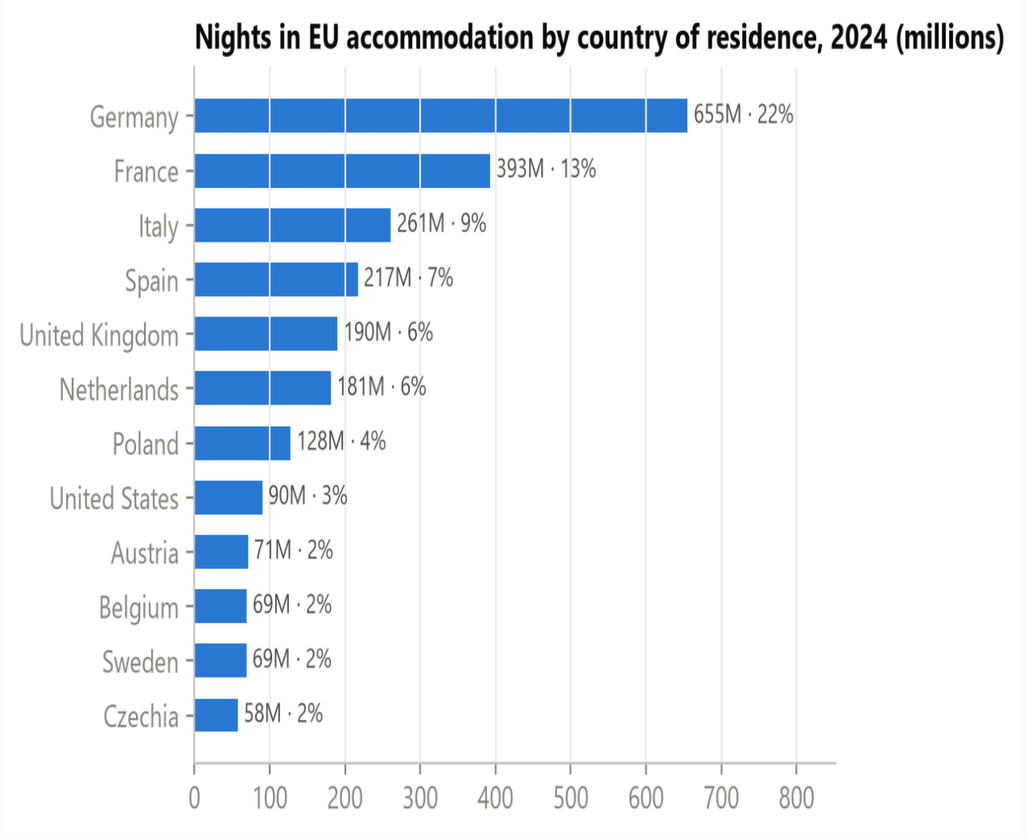
Direct hotel contracts grew ×7.1 between the July 2021 and November 2026 versions of the home page. Public figures differ between pages (190+ vs 220+ source markets; 330+ vs 350+ suppliers; 110K+ agents vs 220K+ clients): each figure is quoted with its page and date.

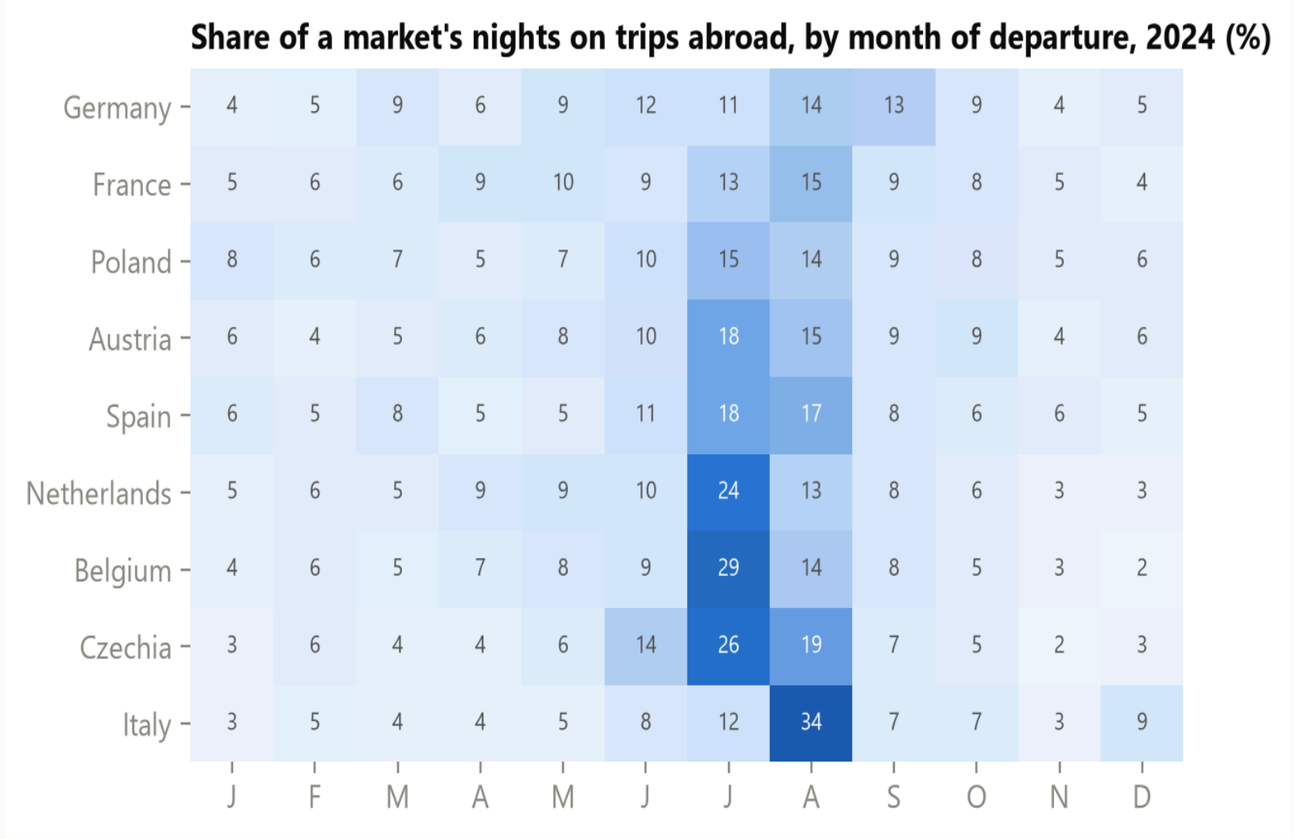
Sources: emergingtravel.com, ratehawk.com, web.archive.org (6 yearly snapshots) · data/public/etg_facts.csv · Independent case study based on public data · not affiliated with or endorsed by Emerging Travel Group

What is normal differs by market: Italians take 34% of their trips abroad in August, Germans spread theirs over half the year

PUBLIC DATA

Eurostat tourism statistics: where hotel nights in the EU come from, and when each source market travels.





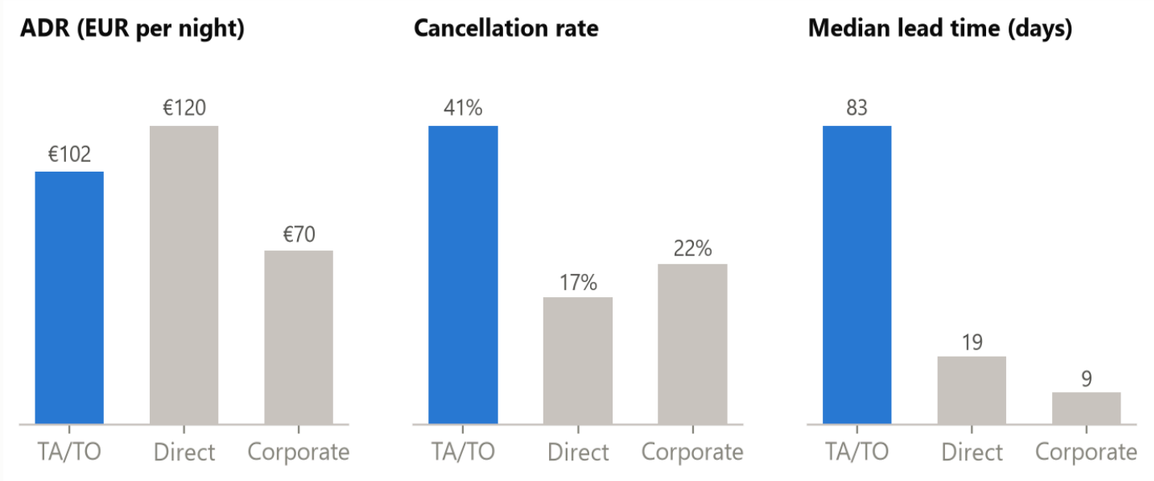
What is "normal" per market Residents of Germany spend the most nights in EU accommodation (domestic stays included), then France, Italy and Spain. Italians take 34% of their nights abroad on trips starting in August; Germans spread theirs (peak month 14%, 7 months above 8%). A 30% jump in Italian bookings for August stays is seasonality, not an anomaly: the cockpit compares each day with the same weekday and last year, and a market calendar explains peaks before anyone calls them a problem. Sweden is left out: its 2024 monthly series is incomplete in the source.

Source: Eurostat tour_occ_ninraw, tour_dem_tnmd (extracted 12 Nov 2026), re-use with attribution · Independent case study based on public data · not affiliated with or endorsed by Emerging Travel Group

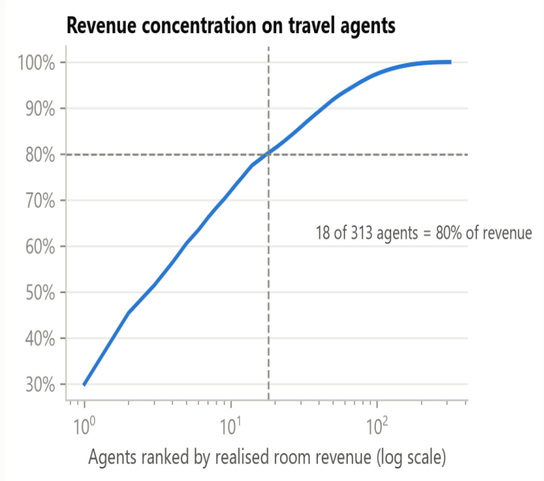
Travel agents bring 82% of bookings but cancel 2.3× more often than direct guests, and ten agents make 72% of agent revenue

REAL DATASET

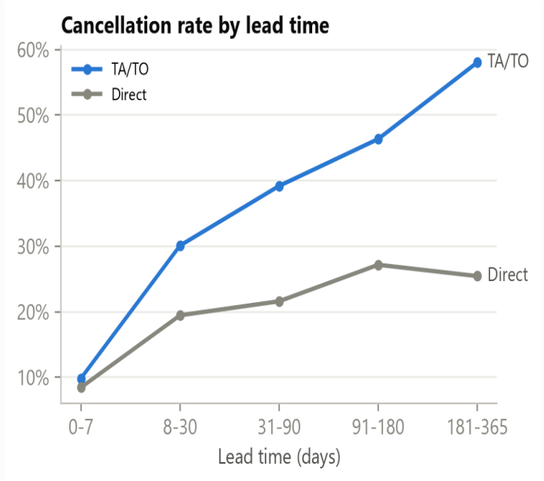
119,390 real bookings by distribution channel. Two hotels in Portugal, 2015-2017, used to demonstrate the analysis, not ETG data.



Travel agents and tour operators (TA/TO, the B2B channel) bring 82% of bookings and 80% of realised room revenue, at a lower nightly rate than direct guests (€102 vs €120), book 4× earlier and cancel 2.3× more often. For a B2B platform this means: price on net rates, watch the cancellation exposure of long lead times, and look at margin after cancellations, not at gross bookings.



The largest agent alone weighs 30% of revenue, the top 10 72%. Losing one key partner moves the whole month (see E2, p.6).



Cancellations rise with lead time in both channels; B2B sits higher at every lead time.

Check before concluding: a suspicious pattern in real data

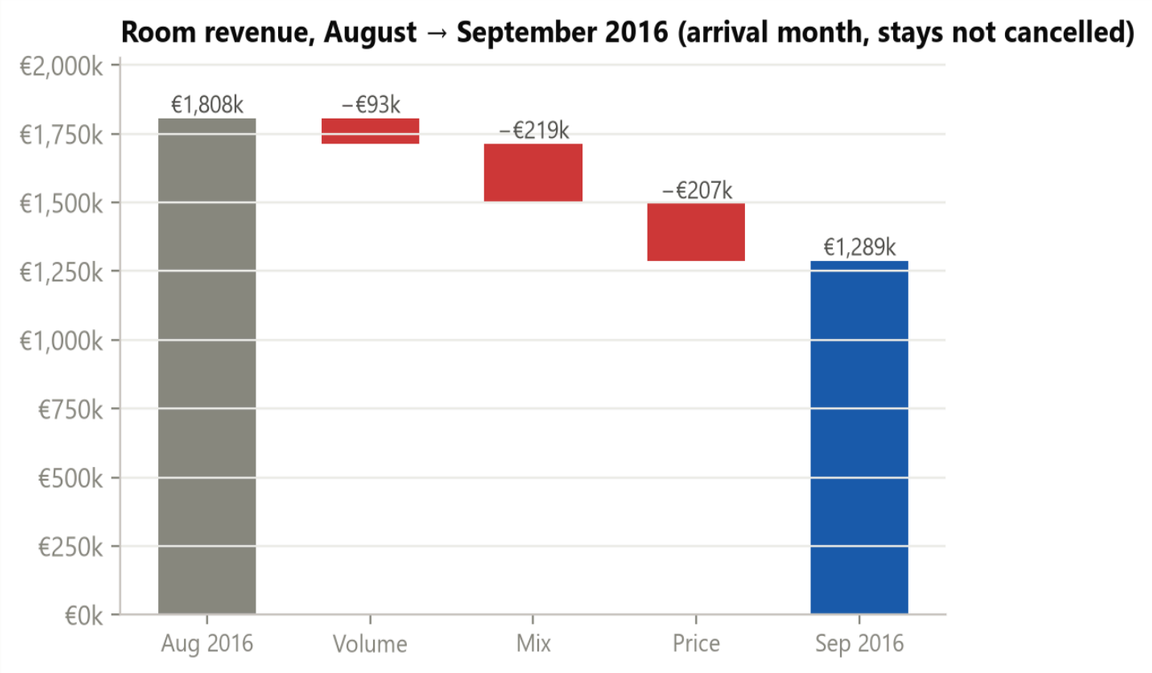
"Non-refundable" bookings show a 99.4% cancellation rate, far above refundable ones (28%). 97% of them come from one country and 94% from TA/TO: most likely a coding convention (e.g. group blocks released by agents), not guests paying for rooms they never use. Treated as a question for the data owner, not as a finding. Other checks: 31,994 identical rows (no booking ID, can be real group bookings: kept and flagged), 715 zero-night stays and 1 negative rate excluded from price statistics.

Data: Antonio, Almeida & Nunes (2019), Hotel booking demand datasets, Data in Brief 22:41-49, CC BY 4.0 · src/analysis_real.py · Independent case study based on public data · not affiliated with or endorsed by Emerging Travel Group

September 2016 revenue fell €519k, yet room nights barely moved: cheaper group business and the end of summer prices explain most of the drop

REAL DATASET

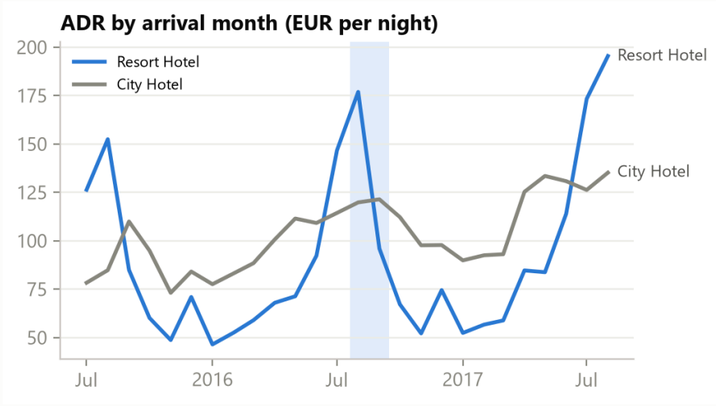
A month-on-month revenue bridge (volume / mix / price) on real bookings, then a top-down search for the cause.



Volume = change in room nights at August's average rate. Mix = nights moving between cheaper and dearer segments. Price = rate change inside each segment. The three add up exactly to the change.

Drill-down: hotel × market segment, largest contributors

Segment	Room nights	ADR	Change
Resort Hotel · Online TA	2,596 → 1,510	€201 → €125	−€333k
Resort Hotel · Direct	1,213 → 693	€212 → €136	−€164k
City Hotel · Online TA	4,620 → 3,309	€125 → €134	−€135k
City Hotel · Offline TA/TO	1,188 → 1,975	€89 → €103	+€97k
Resort Hotel · Groups	0 → 1,018	→ €70	+€71k
Resort Hotel · Offline TA/TO	1,845 → 2,089	€120 → €76	−€64k



Causes, top-down. Total €519k (−29%) → the resort hotel explains 93% of it → room nights only fell from 12,389 to 11,750 (volume €-93k), because a group block refilled the resort at about €70 a night while online-agency and direct guests left after the summer peak (mix €-219k); the resort's rates also dropped from peak to shoulder season (price €-207k). **Reading:** a normal end of season, made worse by low-rate group business. **Action for a platform:** keep group rates above a floor in shoulder months, and push September offers to online-agency partners in August.

Data: Hotel booking demand datasets (CC BY 4.0), arrival months, stays not cancelled · src/analysis_real.py · Independent case study based on public data · not affiliated with or endorsed by Emerging Travel Group

One screen answers "is today normal?" by brand, market, supplier and partner; the weekly and monthly layers catch what a daily alert cannot

SIMULATED

Excel workbook: Power Pivot model with DAX measures, a cockpit built with CUBE formulas, PivotTables with slicers, a statistical alert band and a variance bridge. Screens from the workbook.

Cockpit sheet (CUBE formulas), 15 Sep 2026

Daily commercial cockpit

SIMULATED DATA

Pick a day, a brand and a line of business. Every number below is a CUBE formula reading the Power Pivot data model (measures in DAX).

Day	2026-09-15	Tue
Brand	All	
Line of business	All	
Thresholds:	25% volume gap vs expected	1,5% margin-rate drop (pts) · 4,0% margin floor

Metric	Selected day	Day before	vs D-1	Same day LY	vs LY	Prev. 7-day avg	Expected*	vs expected	Status
Bookings	380	405	-6%	343	+11%	354	418	-9%	OK
Sales (EUR)	123 037	137 922	-11%	113 569	+8%	119 545	140 719	-13%	OK
Margin (EUR)	9 461	10 704	-12%	8 797	+8%	9 333	10 565	-10%	OK
Margin rate	7,7%	7,8%	-0,1%	7,7%	-0,1%	7,8%	7,5%	+0,2%	OK
Room nights	1 034	1 104	-6%	916	+13%	951	1 102	-6%	OK
Avg booking value (EUR)	324	341	-5%	331	-2%	338	337	-4%	OK
Cancellations (by cancel date)	68	82	-17%	68	0%	75	80	-14%	OK

* Expected = average of the same weekday over the previous 4 weeks (handles the weekly pattern). LY = same weekday 52 weeks earlier (364 days).

By brand

Segment	Bookings	Sales (EUR)	Margin rate	Sales expected	Sales vs exp.	Margin exp.	Margin vs exp.	Status
RateHawk	305	97 555	7,0%	112 047	-13%	6,8%	+0,2%	OK
ZenHotels	51	19 315	11,5%	22 304	-13%	11,4%	+0,1%	OK
Roundtrip	24	6 167	6,8%	6 368	-3%	6,5%	+0,3%	OK

By line of business

Segment	Bookings	Sales (EUR)	Margin rate	Sales expected	Sales vs exp.	Margin exp.	Margin vs exp.	Status
Hotels	328	113 729	7,9%	129 153	-12%	7,7%	+0,2%	OK
Transfers	25	1 381	16,1%	1 434	-4%	16,0%	+0,1%	OK
Car rentals	4	707	9,2%	2 471	-71%	10,2%	-1,0%	Alert
Flights	23	7 221	2,6%	7 660	-6%	2,6%	+0,0%	Below floor

By partner type

Segment	Bookings	Sales (EUR)	Margin rate	Sales expected	Sales vs exp.	Margin exp.	Margin vs exp.	Status
Agency	192	60 625	7,9%	63 398	-4%	7,9%	-0,0%	OK
API partner	96	31 950	5,2%	40 681	-21%	5,2%	+0,1%	OK
White label	17	4 980	7,4%	7 969	-38%	6,3%	+1,1%	Alert
Corporate	24	6 167	6,8%	6 368	-3%	6,5%	+0,3%	OK
B2C	51	19 315	11,5%	22 304	-13%	11,4%	+0,1%	OK

By supplier type (Suppliers table)

Segment	Bookings	Sales (EUR)	Margin rate	Sales expected	Sales vs exp.	Margin exp.	Margin vs exp.	Status

Three layers, because one alert rule cannot catch everything

1 · Daily band (Cockpit, Alerts): each segment vs the same weekday of the last 4 weeks, alert at 3.5 standard deviations of its normal noise. 121 alerts in 16 months (~8 a month); it flagged the supplier margin drop (E1), the UAE holiday (E4) and the Greek cancellations (E6) on day one.

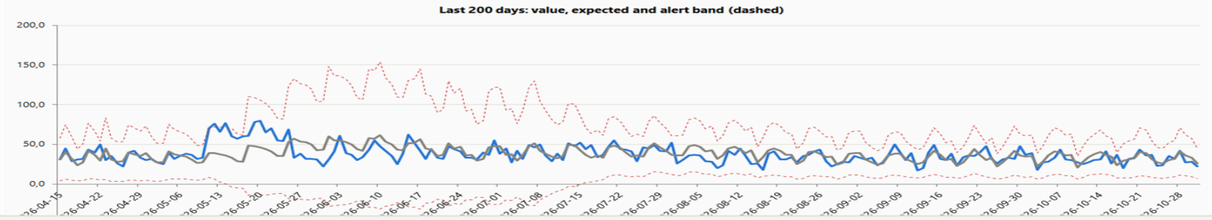
2 · Weekly drill-down (Pivots, sql/04): a partner of 10 bookings a day leaving (E2) stays inside daily noise but tops the weekly list of drops.

3 · Monthly bridge (Bridge): a currency drift of 1-2% a month (E3) never fires a daily alert; it shows as the FX bar.

Alerts sheet: UAE bookings, alert band and the two holiday alerts

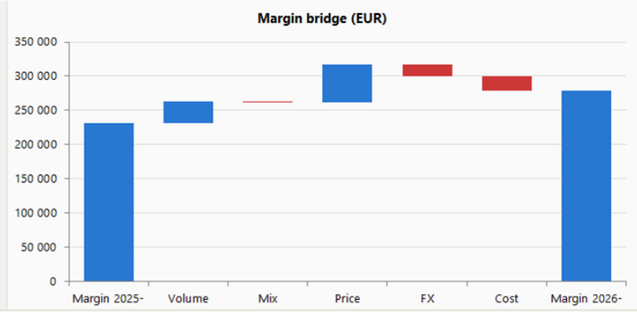
Dimension	client_country	Criteria (helper)	AE	**Alerts in the period**	2
Member	AE	Column (helper)	client_country	Alert days (spill)	2026-05-12 2026-05-14
Metric	bookings				
Alert threshold |z|	3,5				
Min. expected bookings/day	20				

Same rule as src/analysis.py and sql/03_alerts_same_weekday.sql | SIMULATED data (seed 42), not Emerging Travel Group data. Independent case study based on public data - not affiliated with or endorsed by Emerging Travel Group.



Bridge sheet: Sep 2025 → Sep 2026 margin (check cell = 0)

Step	EUR	Base	Up	Down
Margin 2025-09	231 819	0	231 819	0
Volume	31 055	231 819	31 055	0
Mix	-887	261 986	0	887
Price	55 427	261 986	55 427	0
FX	-17 315	300 099	0	17 315
Cost	-20 838	279 261	0	20 838
Margin 2026-09	279 261	0	279 261	0
Check (must be 0)	0			



Six events traced to their cause: the costliest was the quietest, lira price lists lagging the exchange rate (€122k of margin)

SIMULATED

Each incident card: what happened, the evidence, the impact in euros (margin), the recommendation, the owner and the follow-up. Impacts measured from the event start to 31 Oct 2026.

E3 · Currency effect (real TRY depreciation, ECB rates)

−€122,234

What: Turkish partners pay in TRY; the lira lost value against the euro (ECB reference rates)
Evidence: TRY -12% vs EUR (Oct 26 vs Oct 25). Sep-Oct YoY: bookings +16%, sales in TRY +35%, in EUR +18%; margin rate 6.1% vs 8.2% in euro markets
Do: Refresh TRY price lists weekly (not monthly) or quote in EUR/USD; report the market at constant FX
Owner: Pricing + finance (treasury) · **Follow-up:** Constant-FX sales line in the daily report

E1 · Supplier net-rate increase

−€32,556

What: Bedbank C raised its net rates in Spain from 15 Jun 2026; selling prices did not move
Evidence: Margin rate on Bedbank C x Spain 8.5% -> 2.2%; bookings/day 10.5 -> 10.4
Do: Re-route Spain demand to Direct contracts / Bedbank B where cheaper; renegotiate or raise sell rates +5% on affected hotels
Owner: Supply / contracting · **Follow-up:** Daily margin rate on Bedbank C x Spain back above 7%

E2 · Large API partner moved to a competitor

−€10,156

What: API-002 (top partner) ramped down from 7 Sep and stopped on 14 Sep 2026
Evidence: API-002 bookings/day 10 -> 0; it explains 55% of the API channel drop
Do: Account review with the partner: compare our rates on its top 50 hotels, offer a targeted tier rather than a blanket discount
Owner: Key account manager + pricing · **Follow-up:** Weekly volume of API-002; win-back offer within 2 weeks

E4 · Source-market holiday (UAE)

+€12,267

What: Bookings from the UAE jump before the Eid al-Adha holiday (late May 2026)
Evidence: Bookings/day +93% vs the previous 4 weeks; same holiday in 2025 (early June): +64%
Do: Normal seasonality, not an anomaly: align comparisons on the holiday calendar; secure allotments in Turkey/UAE destinations 6 weeks ahead
Owner: Commercial team (market manager UAE) · **Follow-up:** Holiday calendar added to the alert baseline

E6 · Cancellation spike at one destination (Greece)

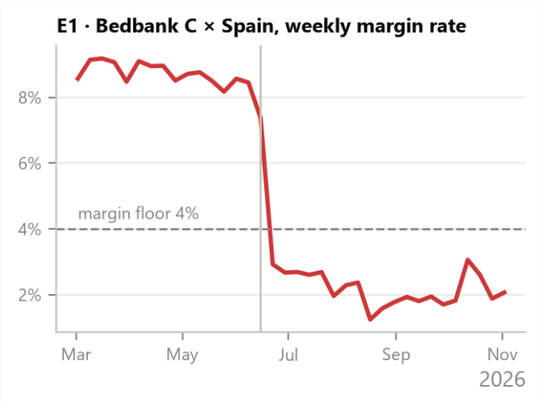
−€4,978

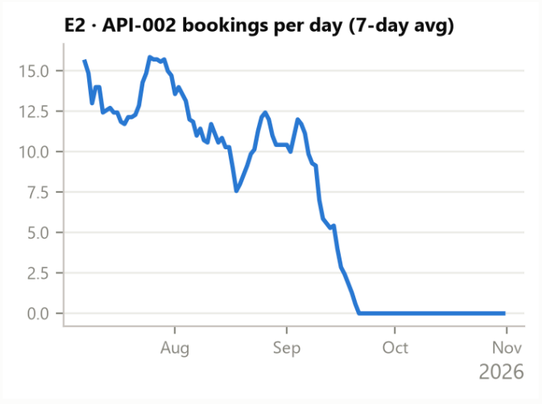
What: A local event (e.g. severe weather) triggered cancellations for mid-August stays
Evidence: Cancellations/day for Greece 14 -> 30 (8-14 Aug 2026)
Do: Offer re-booking to other islands/dates before refund; check supplier cancellation terms (who bears the cost); no price action
Owner: Customer operations + supply · **Follow-up:** Re-booking rate of cancelled Greek stays

E5 · Data-quality issues (page 7)

checked first

Duplicated load, missing supplier costs and a time-zone shift were found and fixed **before** any of the analyses above. Owner: data engineering · Follow-up: automated checks (sql/06) run before the daily report.



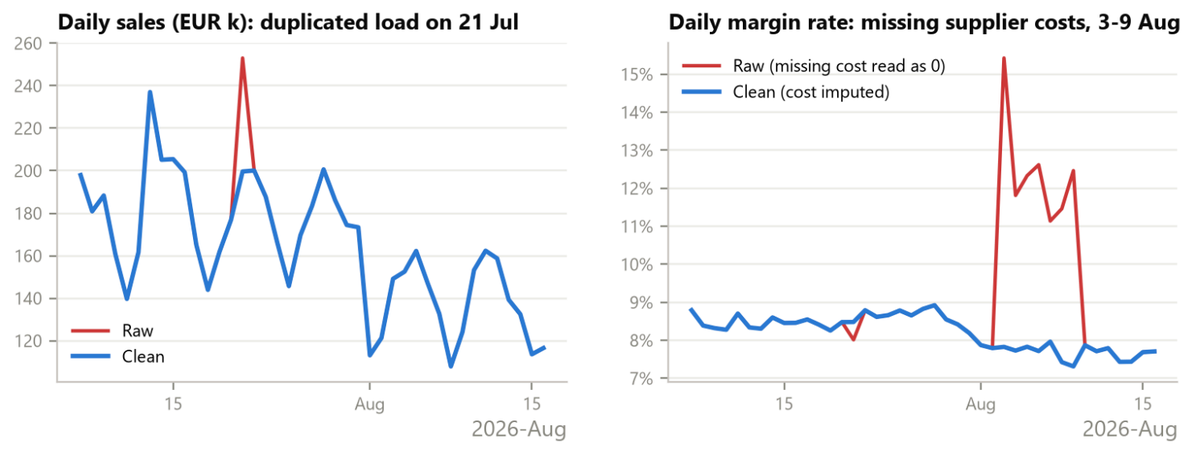


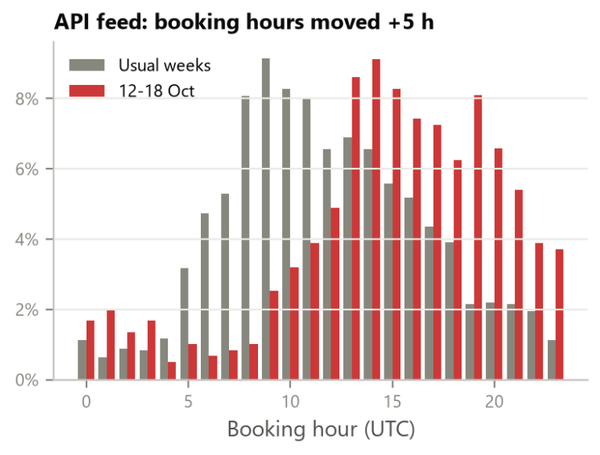
Simulated ledger with programmed events; FX effect uses real ECB rates · src/analysis.py incident_numbers() · Independent case study based on public data · not affiliated with or endorsed by Emerging Travel Group

Three data issues would have produced three wrong conclusions: a 27% sales spike, an inflated margin and bookings on the wrong day

SIMULATED

Checks run on the raw ledger before any number is read (src/analysis.py dq_checks, sql/06_data_quality_checks.sql, Excel Data_Quality sheet).





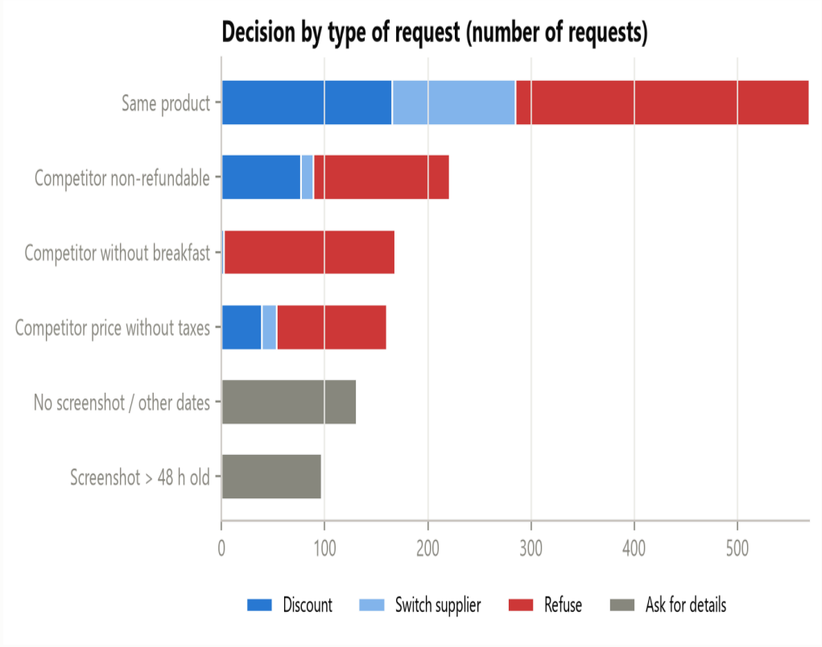
Issue	From	Scope	Rows	Effect if not caught	Action
Duplicated bookings	2026-07-21	Channel API	152	Day sales overstated by +27% (EUR 53,393)	Removed duplicates on booking_id; ask data engineering to fix the load
Missing net cost	2026-08-03	Supplier SUP-WS-A	124	If read as zero, total margin rate shows 12.5% instead of 7.6%	Cost imputed with the supplier's markup of the previous 28 days, flagged; supplier invoice to be reconciled
Time-zone shift in a feed	2026-10-12	Channel API	60	Timestamps +5 h: 60 bookings counted on the wrong day	Shifted back 5 h for the window; feed owner to send UTC
Sold below net cost (business alert, not a data error)	2025-05-01	All bookings	1,498	29% of them on SUP-FL-A	Sent to pricing: selling price below net cost after a supplier rate change or a discount

Checks that returned zero rows: selling price ≤ 0, check-in before booking, cancellation before booking, missing FX rate. Without the checks: 21 July would have shown a 27% sales "record" and the first week of August a margin rate near 12%; the time shift moves late bookings to the next day and breaks any hour-of-day or month-end cut-off analysis. Sold-below-cost bookings are a **business** alert (flight fares in falling currencies, the Spanish supplier rate rise), sent to pricing, not deleted.

58% of price-match claims survive a like-for-like check; the margin floor turns half of all requests into a reasoned no

SIMULATED

Internal requests from partners who saw a lower competitor price: check, decide, reply and track.



1,347 requests in 18 months (~0.7% of bookings). Evidence first, then like-for-like: taxes added back, breakfast valued at €12 per guest-night, free cancellation worth 8% of the price. Then the margin floor decides.

Decision rules (playbook/price_match_rules.md, Excel PriceMatch_Calc)

1. Evidence complete? Same hotel, room, dates, screenshot under 48 h. If not → **ask for details**.
2. Make it like-for-like: competitor price + missing taxes + our breakfast + our flexibility.
3. Real gap ≤ 0 → **refuse**, with the reasons. **4.** Gap ≤ maximum discount (price − net cost / (1 − 4%)) → **discount** the gap. **5.** Else, a cheaper supplier keeps the floor → **switch supplier**. **6.** Else → **refuse**: the floor is not negotiable, offer alternatives.

Decision	Share	Booked after	Median handling
Discount	21%	83%	3.1 h
Switch supplier	11%	76%	3.1 h
Refuse	51%	36%	3.3 h
Ask for details	17%	47%	1.1 h

Discounts granted on booked requests cost €2,668; discount + switch kept €133,877 of sales.

Saying no, with arguments (templates)

Not the same product. "Thank you for flagging this. We checked the offer: the competitor rate is non-refundable and excludes taxes, ours can be cancelled free of charge and includes taxes. Compared like-for-like, our price is the better offer, so we keep it."

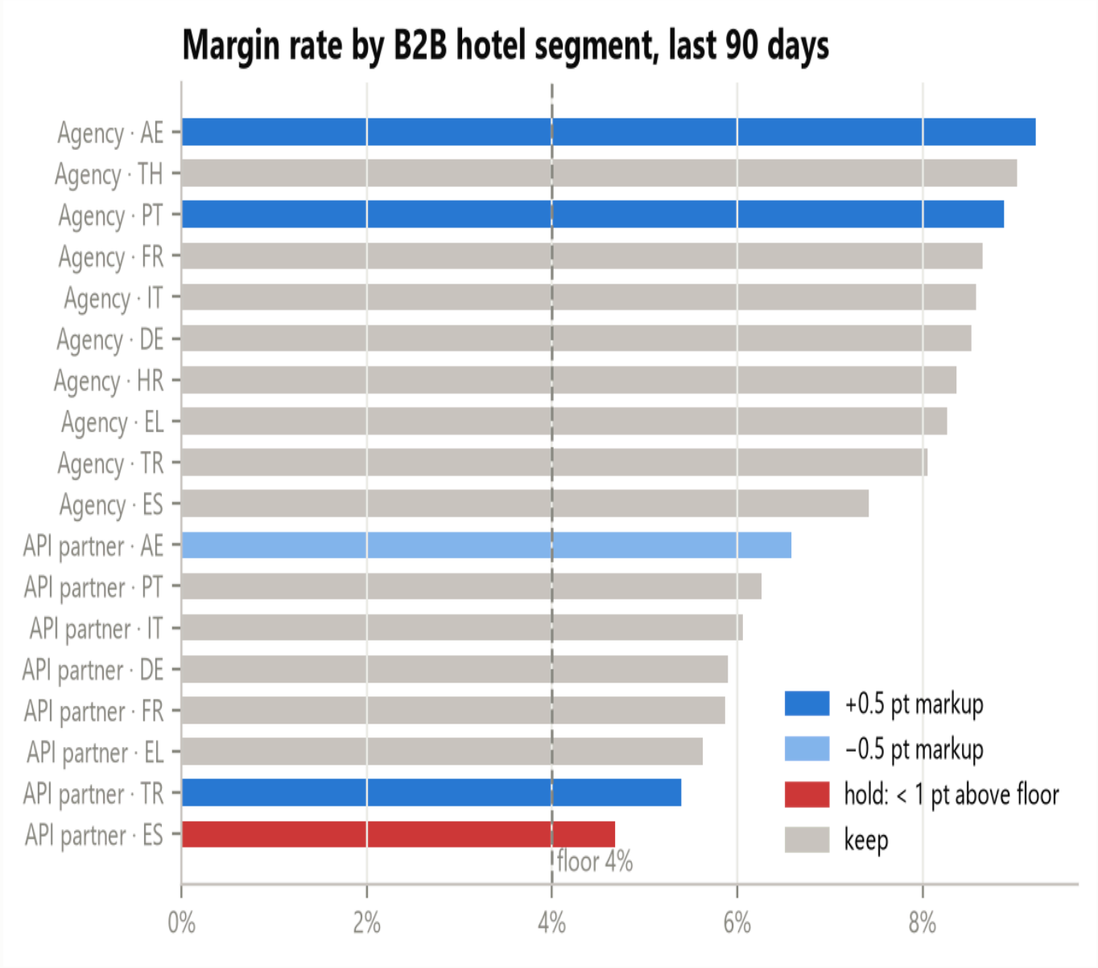
Margin floor. "We checked carefully: the difference comes from the supplier cost for these dates and we cannot go lower without selling at a loss. We can offer two similar hotels nearby at a better price."

Missing evidence. "To review the price, please send a screenshot from the last 48 hours with hotel, room type, dates, meal plan, cancellation policy and total with taxes."

Move markups by half points where the data supports it, and hold the segments squeezed by the supplier rate rise

SIMULATED

B2B hotel segments (partner type × destination), last 90 days: margin, valid price-match pressure and growth decide the move; the expected effect is a range, not a point.



Recommended moves (90-day effect, elasticity −1 to −3)

Segment	Margin	Valid PM / 1,000	Volume YoY	Markup	Margin effect
API partner · AE	6.6%	7.4	+8%	-0.5 pt	−€1,134 to −€1,304
API partner · TR	5.4%	3.3	+11%	+0.5 pt	+€879 to +€1,005
Agency · AE	9.2%	1.7	+14%	+0.5 pt	+€1,817 to +€2,312
Agency · PT	8.9%	3.8	+22%	+0.5 pt	+€1,079 to +€1,358

Hold and renegotiate: API partner · ES (margin 4.7%, within 1 pt of the floor after the supplier rate rise).
Read the −0.5 pt carefully: it loses margin at any plausible elasticity. With a 7.0% markup, a 0.5 pt cut needs +7.6% volume just to break even. It is worth it only to keep partners from leaving (the E2 risk); otherwise resource cheaper supply first.
Rules: −0.5 pt where valid price-match pressure is in the top quartile and growth below 10%; +0.5 pt where pressure is low and growth above 10%; never below a 4% margin floor. Elasticity is an assumption: the effect is a range, total +€2,641 to +€3,371 over 90 days. Small on purpose: markups move by half points, and only where the data supports it.

Follow-up plan

Week 0: apply changes on 5% of traffic (A/B by partner) · Weeks 1-4: daily cockpit on test vs control (bookings, margin, price-match requests) · Week 4: keep, extend or roll back; re-estimate elasticity from the test instead of the assumption.

Methods, limits & AI note

How the data was collected, what is assumed, and what this study cannot say.

Sources and licences

ETG public pages emergingtravel.com, ratehawk.com, zenhotels.com (live, 12 Nov 2026) and six archived home pages (web.archive.org, 2021-2026). robots.txt checked, one request every 2.5 s, no login, no prices collected.
Eurostat tour_occ_ninraw, tour_dem_tnmd, tour_occ_nim, Eurostat re-use policy (attribution).
ECB euro foreign exchange reference rates (EXR, daily), ECB Data Portal, re-use with attribution.
Hotel booking demand datasets N. Antonio, A. de Almeida, L. Nunes, Data in Brief 22 (2019) 41-49, doi:10.1016/j.dib.2018.11.126, CC BY 4.0 (TidyTuesday mirror, 2020-02-11).
Competitor prices are never collected: all price-match comparisons are simulated.
Full list with dates: data/SOURCES.md.

Simulation and assumptions

18 months (May 2025 - Oct 2026), daily, ~350 bookings a day (about 1:50 of ETG's public "130k+ bookings weekly"), seed 42. Brands, lines of business, 13 source markets, 10 destinations, 27 fictional suppliers, 2,138 fictional partners. Markups 6.5-14% by partner type (assumption); local price lists refreshed monthly; real ECB rates; Eurostat seasonality. Seven programmed events (supplier rate, lost partner, FX, holiday, data issues, cancellations, price matches), all found by the monitoring. All assumptions: data/ASSUMPTIONS.md.

Reproduce

python src/collect_*.py → simulate.py → analysis_real.py → analysis.py → run_sql.py → build_excel.py (Windows + Excel 365) → build_report.py. README.md lists every step.

Limits

The real booking dataset is old (2015-2017) and covers two hotels in one country: it shows methods, not today's market. The ledger is simulated: patterns are realistic by construction, so the findings show the process, not ETG's results. Public ETG figures are marketing headlines ("+") that differ between pages. Elasticities are assumptions. Eurostat covers EU destinations and EU residents' trips only.

AI note

AI-assisted workflow: I used Claude, mainly to write scripts faster. I drove the project: I defined the questions, chose and validated the data sources, made the analytical decisions and checked every result.